

rest assured that I've done my research and am making the right decisions for me at this time.

- I don't have the capacity for unpaid work at the moment, unfortunately. If circumstances change and you're able to offer a fee, please get in touch.

Anticipate some push back, and have a response prepared

When you put in a new boundary, not everyone will understand or accept to begin with, especially if you've struggled to say no in the past – think Hannah Horvath's parents cutting her off financially in the opening episode of *Girls*, and the outrage that she reacts with. Similarly, you might consider that if a person you are close to were to change their boundaries with you, you might be resistant to the altered dynamic, at least to begin with. Try to respond neutrally and firmly, rather than getting upset that the other person is not respecting your boundary – this can be hard if you struggled to enforce the boundary in the first place, but it's important not to undo that hard work now. Try phrases like:

- I did already give you an answer, and it was no. I'm sorry if that wasn't the answer you wanted to hear, but it is final.
- As I told you, it's not affordable for me right now.
- Please respect my original answer.
- I thought carefully about my decision, so please respect it.